

Krishnaa Vadivel | GPU Software Engineer | High-Performance Computing | Scientific ML

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Profile

GPU-focused computational scientist and PhD researcher with experience spanning accelerator-enabled scientific software, large-scale simulation, and machine learning for scientific computing. Develops Python and C++ applications with CUDA, ROCm, MPI, and OpenMP, and deploys them on national-lab HPC systems for first-principles and many-body materials workloads.

Research Experience

Yale University, Electrical Engineering

Research Assistant / PhD Researcher

2021–present

- Developed distributed scientific software in Python and C++ with MPI, OpenMP, PETSc, and SLEPc for large linear-algebra and simulation workloads as part of an INCITE award using exascale resources on Frontier at OLCF, Perlmutter at LBNL, and related national-lab HPC systems.
- Ported and optimized computational workloads for accelerator-enabled environments using CUDA and ROCm, translating many-body and excited-state physics methods into scalable GPU-backed implementations.
- Developed many-body and field-theoretic formulations of coupled electron, exciton, and phonon systems, including coherent-state and path-integral approaches for time-dependent and self-localized states.
- Used PyTorch, PyTorch Geometric, and equivariant graph neural networks to accelerate self-trapped-exciton calculations and related materials simulations in GPU-backed workflows.
- Packaged scientific applications in Docker containers for deployment across different computing environments and used TotalView, Linaro DDT, Bash, and Linux command-line tools to debug distributed applications.
- Co-authored a 2025 *Journal of the American Chemical Society* paper and presented APS talks in 2024, 2025, and 2026 on self-trapped exciton formation, exciton-polarons, and related excited-state materials physics.

Professional Experience

Probe Technologies Inc. / Weatherford Wireline Services

Software and Embedded Systems Engineer

2019–2021

- Built CUDA-based data-processing pipelines and GPU-enabled engineering tooling for large acoustic waveform datasets generated by downhole logging tools.
- Built full-stack server applications with C#, ASP.NET, and Microsoft SQL Server for database design, real-time remote tool testing, and calibration of temperature and pressure sensors.
- Applied finite-element analysis with dolfinx for frequency analysis of steel pipes in well environments to support in-house physics and engineering studies.

FindLight

Photonics Technical Writer

2018–2019

- Produced technical articles and product-facing photonics content covering lasers, optics, and optoelectronic components for a specialized engineering readership.

Selected Projects

Accelerator-Enabled Exciton-Phonon Simulation

- Developed distributed first-principles calculations for excited-state and exciton-phonon problems with CUDA, ROCm, MPI, and OpenMP on leadership-class GPU clusters.

Scientific ML on GPU Systems

- Developed PyTorch Geometric equivariant models for molecular-property prediction and for accelerating scientific calculations in GPU-backed workflows.
CUDA Containers for HPC Software
- Packaged scientific software in CUDA-ready Docker environments for portable deployment across local and HPC systems.
Matrix-Multiply AI Accelerator
- Built a Verilog-based matrix-multiply accelerator project for AI-oriented datapath design and hardware-software performance exploration.
Integrated Photonics and FDTD Modeling
- Designed photonic structures including nanophotonic ring-resonator band-pass filters in telecom bands with Meep-based FDTD simulation.

Education

Yale University

PhD, Electrical Engineering

2021–present

Ongoing doctoral research in computational materials, many-body theory, and accelerator-enabled scientific computing.

Yale University

MPhil, Electrical Engineering

2023

Yale University

MS, Electrical Engineering

2023

Cornell University

MEng, Electrical and Computer Engineering

2017–2018

Included work in stochastic computing, device-oriented EE topics, and advanced design coursework.

Cornell University

BS, Electrical and Computer Engineering

2013–2017

Included embedded systems, robotics, and core mathematics, physics, and computing foundations.

Selected Publications

2025: de Paula, A. M., Li, S., Hou, B., Vadivel, S., Teles-Ferreira, D. C., Iudica, A., Kabacinski, P., Hosseini, H., McArthur, J., Cerullo, G., et al. (2025). Time-domain observation of ultrafast self-trapped exciton formation in lead-free double halide perovskites. *Journal of the American Chemical Society*, 147(32), 28923–28931.

Selected Conference Presentations

2026: Vadivel, S., Grande, R. D., Strubbe, D. A., & Qiu, D. Y. (2026). First-principles study of exciton-polarons and self-trapped excitons. *APS Global Physics Summit 2026*.

2025: Vadivel, S., Qiu, D. Y., Grande, R. D., & Strubbe, D. A. (2025). First-principles study of self-trapped exciton formation in double perovskites. *APS Global Physics Summit 2025*.

2024: Vadivel, S., & Qiu, D. (2024). First-principles study of self-trapped exciton formation in double perovskites using excited state forces. *APS March Meeting Abstracts 2024*, F01–007.

Selected Coursework

Mathematics: Differential Geometry; Abstract Algebra; Honors Mathematical Analysis II

Computer Science: Theoretical Computer Science; Probabilistic Machine Learning

Physics: Graduate Quantum Mechanics I–II; Solid State Physics I–II; Many-Body Quantum Physics

Electrical Engineering: Semiconductor Physics; Thin Film Science; Lasers and Optoelectronics; Integrated Photonics; VLSI Design; Analog VLSI Design; Mathematics of Signals and Systems; Advanced Embedded Systems

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, C, C++, CUDA, JavaScript, Bash, PowerShell, SQL, C#

GPU / HPC: CUDA, ROCm, MPI, OpenMP, PETSc, SLEPc, mpi4py, petsc4py, slepc4py, Frontier, Perlmutter

Machine Learning: PyTorch, PyTorch Geometric, scikit-learn, equivariant graph neural networks

Systems: Linux command line, macOS, Windows, CMake, Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes, gcloud, ASP.NET, Microsoft SQL Server

Debugging / Domains: TotalView, Linaro DDT, distributed-application debugging, GPU computing, first-principles materials modeling, many-body theory